

SHATTA AND THE STREET RECEIPTS

POLITICS

Dear Osagyefo, It has been too long since I've written to you about the pulse of our motherland. My pen has been heavy, and my usual witty tone felt utterly inappropriate. Ghana has been draped in a dark cloak of mourning, and the grief is still raw. It began with the loss of Charles Kofo Fosu, a musician so profound, so iconic, that his passing felt like the silencing of a national song. We are still reeling from his absence, yet tragedy kept striking. His death was just the beginning. Next, a horrifying road accident claimed the lives of 16 vibrant young souls, futures extinguished in an instant. Then, as if the heavens themselves were weeping, a helicopter crash in the Ashanti region stole five government officials and three crew members. And here, Osagyefo, is where my heart turns to fire. In the wake of these devastating events, a bizarre narrative has emerged. Where were our great prophets? They were silent on the musician and the innocent youth, yet they somehow "prophesied" the final tragedy, the one that involved those in power. In a move that feels like a slap to the face of every ordinary citizen, a new government office has been created, dedicated solely to these prophecies about officials. It seems the lives of our everyday people, the ones who truly make up this nation, don't matter enough to warrant a divine warning. It appears those not in government do not matter. The message is as clear as day, and it burns with an injustice that cannot be ignored.

This week, Ghana was gripped by a new saga involving a gentleman named Ralph and Ridge Hospital. The narrative goes that Ralph, hearing of some commotion at the hospital's emergency unit, rushed there to capture the scene on camera. In a twist of fate, he was involved in an accident on the way and became a patient himself. After a frustrating wait and a request to get a medical card, he lost his temper, assaulted a nurse, and recorded the entire incident to share online. His actions have sparked a heated debate. Some believe he went too far, while others, who have endured terrible experiences with healthcare professionals, are supporting him. This incident highlights a crucial point that needs to be explained to the Ghanaian public: the system of triage in emergency units. The emergency room is not like a "waakye" queue where people are served on a first-come, first-served basis. It's also not an outpatient department. Nurses and staff must prioritize patients based on the severity of their conditions. You might be the first person to arrive with a minor cut, but someone with a bleeding wound or difficulty breathing will be treated first, this is standard procedure in every emergency room worldwide. We must also consider the nurse-to-patient ratio, which is often critically low, leading to inevitable delays in care.

Nevertheless, the attitudes of some healthcare professionals are genuinely appalling. It's not uncommon to see nurses on duty doing TikTok live streams. Regardless of whether this is done during breaks, the optics are terrible, making it seem as though some healthcare workers are insensitive to the plight of the sick. We've also heard stories of nurses on night duty who nap, and doctors who sleep at home, having to be called in for emergencies. This kind of negligence is

unacceptable when human lives are at stake.

Finally, we come to the grand finale of this week's drama: the "Dancehall King" himself, Shatta Wale. For a man who's built his brand on the mantra of "Paah Paah", a sound that, as it turns out, is anything but golden. All that extensive bragging about his wealth and his "street" connections has landed him in a very different kind of street: a legal one. He was recently a special guest of the Economic and Organized Crime Office (EOCO) for a little chat about a Lamborghini he supposedly bought "off the streets." Apparently, he's so good at keeping his past in the rearview mirror that he can't seem to locate the paper trail or even remember the person he "got the car from."

The plot thickens with a delicious dose of irony. The car's real owner, a Mr. Amugi, is currently enjoying a stay in a U.S. prison and needs the luxury vehicle back for restitution. It's safe to say Shatta Wale is in deep waters, the kind you can't just sail a yacht through. And in a final act of devotion that could only happen in Ghana, while their artist and his lawyer were being interrogated, his fans showed up at the EOCO premises. They didn't come to protest; they came to dance to his music. Because when your king is in trouble, what else is there to do but throw a party? I promise continue updating you, Ato_KD